

All creatures of the earth and sky

See also: All creatures worship God most high

Text: Saint Francis of Assisi, 1225; alt.

Music: Geistliche Kirchengesang, 1623

LASST UNS ERFREUEN LM

arr. Ralph Vaughan Williams, 1906

The musical score is written for a three-part setting (Soprano, Alto, and Bass) in 3/4 time, with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#). The score is divided into four systems. The first system contains the first three verses of the hymn. The second system contains the 'alleluia' refrain. The third system contains the continuation of the verses. The fourth system contains the final 'alleluia' refrain. Above the vocal staves, the chords for each measure are indicated: E, C#m, Bsus B, E, C#m, Bsus B in the first system; E, A, E, F#, B in the second system; E, Bsus B, E, A, E in the third system; and A, B, E, F#m, B, C#m, F#, B, C#m, F#m, B, F#m, Bsus B7, E in the fourth system. The lyrics are written below the vocal staves, with three parts of the text aligned under the Soprano, Alto, and Bass staves respectively.

1 All crea-tures of the earth and sky, come, kin-dred, lift your voic-es high,
2 Swift rush-ing wind so wild and strong, white clouds that sail in heav'n a-long,
3 Cool flow-ing wa-ter pure and clear, make mu-sic for all life to hear,

al-le-lu-ia, al-le-lu-ia!

Bright burn-ing sun with gold-en beam, soft shin-ing moon with sil-ver gleam,
Fair ris-ing morn in praise re-joice, high stars of eve-ning find a voice,
Dance, flame of fire, so strong and bright, and bless us with your warmth and light,

O sing ye, O sing ye, al-le-lu-ia, al-le-lu-ia, al-le-lu-ia!

3. Embracing earth, you, day by day,
bring forth your blessings on our way,
alleluia, alleluia!
All herbs and fruits that richly grow,
let them the glory also show,
O sing ye, O sing ye, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia!

4. All you of understanding heart,
forgiving others, take your part
alleluia, alleluia!
Let all things now the good possess,
and search out truth in humbleness
O sing ye, O sing ye, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia!